The $100K App Sprint: Find It, Build It, Ship It

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Background / Context

A new wave of solo builders is quietly making life-changing money from apps that sound absurd on paper. A pet portrait service built on Lovable that turns your dog's photo into a Renaissance painting and ships it to your door is now pulling in $100K per month. Quittr, a habit-breaking app built by two founders in their teens and early twenties with just $3,000 of their own money, hit 350,000 downloads across 120 countries and crossed $1.1 million in total revenue within six months. A single TikTok video for Quittr generated 10 million views and $100,000 in revenue. Co-Star, an AI astrology app that gives users personalized horoscopes based on NASA data, has surpassed 30 million global users. None of these are billion-dollar platforms backed by venture capital. They're small, sharp, emotionally resonant products built by tiny teams in days or weeks.

The economics of software have fundamentally shifted. Tools like Cursor, Bolt, Replit, and Lovable have collapsed the time and skill required to go from idea to working product. Lovable alone has seen over 25 million projects created in its first year. What used to take a team of engineers three months can now be built by one person in a weekend. The bottleneck is no longer code. The bottleneck is taste, speed, and the instinct to spot an idea people will actually pay for.

Zach AI, one of India's most adaptable and pioneering AI agencies, is sponsoring this track because this is exactly where we're headed. Our focus going forward is building applications and software that help or entertain the everyday person while staying ahead of the monthly-changing trends in AI. We're looking for builders who can spot opportunity, ship fast, and create products people actually want to use. The winner of this track gets more than a prize: you get a direct path to building alongside us.

Problem to Solve

Identify a "stupidly simple" yet high-potential app concept and build a fully functional, shippable prototype. The app should be something a real user would download, pay for, and tell their friends about. Think small, think weird, think sticky.

This is not about technical complexity. This is about product instinct combined with rapid execution.

Objectives

Participants should aim to build a solution that:

✓ Taps into a real emotional trigger, guilty pleasure, or overlooked frustration
✓ Sounds dumb when you explain it but makes perfect sense when you use it
✓ Feels polished and delightful, not like a hackathon demo
✓ Has a clear viral or organic growth mechanic baked into the product
✓ Demonstrates the builder's ability to go from zero to shippable in minimal time
✓ Makes the judges say "that's so dumb... I would totally download that"

Expected Capabilities

The solution may include features such as:

- A core interaction loop that is immediately understandable (no onboarding needed)
- AI-powered personalization or content generation that adds real value
- Monetization mechanics (subscription, one-time purchase, freemium, in-app purchase)
- Shareability features (results people want to screenshot, social hooks, referral loops)
- Clean, intuitive UI that prioritizes delight over feature count
- A landing page or App Store-style description that sells the concept

Scope and Constraints

In Scope:

Participants may build solutions involving:

- Web apps, mobile apps (iOS/Android), or progressive web apps
- AI-powered features using any LLM, image generation, or multimodal API
- Vibe coding tools (Cursor, Bolt, Replit, v0, Lovable, or similar)
- Traditional development with any language or framework
- Any monetization model or payment integration (simulated is fine)
- Trend research, market validation, and competitor analysis as part of the process

Technologies Allowed:

- Any AI-assisted development tool or code editor
- Large Language Models or multimodal AI APIs
- Any frontend or mobile framework (React, Flutter, SwiftUI, etc.)
- No-code or low-code platforms if they produce a polished result
- Any design tool for UI/UX
- Any public API or third-party service

Data Sources Allowed:

- Public App Store and Play Store data for market research
- Social media trends (Reddit, TikTok, X/Twitter) for idea validation
- Public datasets and open-source assets
- User-provided or synthetic content

Out of Scope:

Participants are NOT required to:

- Publish the app to any app store
- Handle legal compliance, terms of service, or privacy policies
- Build infrastructure that scales to thousands of users
- Implement real payment processing (simulated checkout flows are acceptable)
- Have prior app development experience

Expected Deliverables

Teams should provide:

✓ A working app prototype (web or mobile) that can be demoed live
✓ A 2-minute pitch covering: what it is, who would use it, and why they would pay
✓ Market validation evidence (competitor gaps, trending demand, social proof, or user research)
✓ A clear monetization strategy with projected price points
✓ Source code repository

Optional:

- App Store-style listing (screenshots, description, pricing)
- Evidence of user testing or early feedback
- Growth and distribution strategy
- Revenue projections based on comparable apps

Evaluation Focus

Solutions will be assessed based on:

- **Idea Quality (30%):** Is this a real opportunity? Is the concept sharp, unexpected, and easy to explain in one sentence?
- **Product Taste and UX (25%):** Does the app feel polished? Is the experience delightful? Would you show this to a friend?
- **Market Awareness (20%):** Did the team validate the idea? Do they understand who the customer is and how to reach them?
- **Execution and Shippability (15%):** How close to a real launch is this? Could it go live next week?
- **Technical Implementation (10%):** Is the code clean enough to maintain and iterate on?